Workshop handout

Digital Innovation Tools for Effective Communication between Young People and Local Authorities

Nicu Calcea

Facilitator: Nicu Calcea, SAMIZDATA
Date and time: Saturday, 7 November 2026, [time TBC]
Venue: Online, [Zoom link TBC]
Organised by: ALDA Moldova, as part of the SG4Y-CLIMATE project

Why this workshop?

How cities cope with climate change is decided at the international, national and level. These decisions are made based on information such as budgets, contracts, measurements and plans. Much of this information is public, or should be.

Young people are crucial for bringing new ideas and perspectives on environmental issues, but any campaign needs to be built on authoritative data in order not to be dismissed. A campaign that presents clear evidence, names the public authority responsible and asks for a specific outcome is likely to be much more succesful.

This workshop will cover practical, free digital tools that make it possible for young people to find and check open data on climate and the environment, request it when it isn't available, and present it in a compelling way.

What will we explore?

During the session, participants will:

- Learn what open data is, why it matters, and how to use it.
- Find climate and environmental data at the local, national and European level, and assess how complete and usable it is.
- Try free tools for exploring, mapping and visualising data such as Datawrapper.
- Compare youth participation mechanisms in Moldova, Romania and Türkiye, from the Council of Europe down to city level.

- Understand access-to-information laws in the three countries to request data that isn't published.
- Turn evidence into a campaign sketch that a mayor, a city council or the Council of Europe can act on.

Key questions

The workshop will try to answer the following questions:

- What does a claim need behind it before it goes in front of a mayor or into a policy paper?
- Where is climate and environmental data published for our cities, and how good is it?
- What can we do when the information we need isn't public?
- How do we present our results honestly and clearly?

Before the session

Participants are asked to identify one claim central to their project and find the best evidence for it. They will write down who holds this evidence, what's missing from it, and who could hold the better evidence.

This will then serve as the starting point for their work in the first exercise during the workshop.

During the session

Time	Block
00:00	Introductions
00:10	Core concepts: what open data is, why we need it, how to find and use it
00:30	Databases and tools: where to find environmental data and how to analyse and visualise it
01:00	Exercise 1: in groups, find and identify data relevant to your projects and fill in a data quality table
01:30	Break
01:40	Requesting information: what to ask for, who to ask, and what the law says
01:50	Exercise 2: in groups, turn the evidence into a campaign sketch
02:20	Conclusions and next steps
02:30	Close

After the session

Participants should feel confident to send requests for additional information and data to relevant authorities if they identify any gaps in their evidence.

Once they receive all the information they need, they can finish the exercises and turn them into the evidence annex of a policy paper, or into a page for the project website comparing data transparency and quality on your topic, with recommendations and campaign ideas.